

## A long time coming

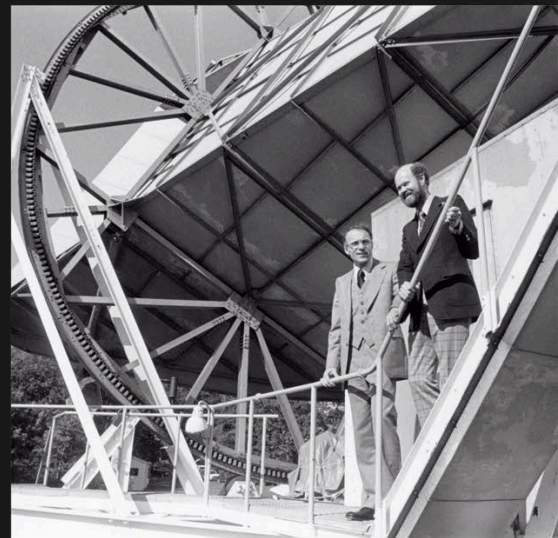
Matter only began to form hundreds of thousands of years after the Big Bang – long after the fireball had cooled. The resulting gases would form the stars, planets, and galaxies that exist today.

At 9 billion years, the Universe looks much as it does today, if a little bit smaller. Our Sun starts to form.

Stars and galaxies start to form after about 300 million years.

## What's that?

Scientists have detected a faint radio signal, present in any direction they look for it in space. They believe it is a faint glow from the Big Bang's superhot fireball. It is called The Cosmic Background Radiation.



The Cosmic Background Radiation was discovered by American physicists Arno Penzias and Robert Wilson in the 1960s.

## No beginning, no end

An alternative to the Big Bang, the Steady State Theory claimed there was no beginning or end for the Universe. It's just always been there.

Few scientists now believe in the Steady State Theory.

## weird or what?

The astronomer who gave the Big Bang theory its name didn't support it. He termed it Big Bang as a criticism and was surprised that the name stuck. He believed in the Steady State Theory.